Arabic Phonetics and Transcription

Example Author

Example Institution

Arabic / Phonetics Assignment

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$$\dot{x} = \sigma(y - x),$$
$$\dot{y} = x(\rho - z) - y,$$
$$\dot{z} = xy - \beta z$$

σ=10, ρ=28, β=$\frac{8}{3}$

1 Scope and transcription conventions

This is an English-first study report with Arabic passages and left-to-right IPA. The examples use illustrative Modern Standard Arabic citation forms; case endings and dialectal realizations are not exhaustively represented. They are teaching examples, not transcriptions of an analyzed recording.

Study record. Record the variety, speaker/source, task, timestamp, transcription convention, and uncertain alternatives before making claims about actual pronunciation.

2 Arabic spelling, vowel marks, and IPA

An English sentence may contain Arabic كِتَاب followed by its broad transcription /kita:b/ and the gloss ‘book’. Keep spelling, transliteration, and IPA distinct: a Latin transliteration is not automatically a phonetic transcription.

Table 1: Constructed vocabulary examples; pronunciations are illustrative citation forms.

Arabic	Broad IPA	Meaning
كِتَاب	/kita:b/	book
بَيْت	/bajt/	house
شَمْس	/ʃams/	sun
قَلْب	/qalb/	heart

(1) **A place contrast** Compare كَلْب /kalb/ ‘dog’ with قَلْب /qalb/ ‘heart’. In the stated convention, the contrast is /k/ versus /q/.

(2) **Gemination and vowels** دَرَسَ /darasa/ ‘he studied’ and دَرَّسَ /dar:asa/ ‘he taught’ illustrate the shadda and a consonant-length distinction in these forms.

Phonetic detail. Use square brackets for a narrower realization, such as a form you actually heard. Do not infer aspiration, vowel quality, or pharyngealization from the spelling alone. The IPA font also supports study notation such as ħ ʕ x ɣ sˤ tˤ aː t͡ʃ.

3 Right-to-left passages and mixed direction

The following paragraph contains Arabic script and a deliberately embedded left-to-right IPA span. It is a typesetting demonstration.

هٰذَا كِتَابٌ. نَدْرُسُ أَصْوَاتَ اللُّغَةِ الْعَرَبِيَّةِ. نَكْتُبُ كَلِمَةَ كِتَاب هٰكَذَا: /kita:b/.

English resumes here with its normal direction, punctuation, and numbering. Use the explicit inline or paragraph wrappers rather than manually reversing Arabic letters. Numerals can be entered directly in the required form: ١٢٣ and 123.

4 Transcription worksheet

Table 2: Template for recording evidence and transcription decisions.

Source / item	Proposed form	Notes / confidence
Constructed example	/kita:b/	No recording was analyzed
Recording 1	—	Record source, time, variety, alternatives
Recording 2	—	Compare broad and narrow transcriptions

5 Writing and verification

Use `\arabictext{...}` for an inline Arabic span and the `arabicparagraph` environment for a paragraph. Existing `\ipa`, `\phonemic`, and `\phonetic` commands remain left-to-right inside those spans. Arabic is rendered with Amiri; IPA uses Charis SIL. HarfBuzz handles shaping.

Inspect joined letters, shadda/vowel placement, parentheses, table columns, and mixed-direction punctuation in the PDF. Arabic has no uppercase/lowercase pairing; retain English report metadata unless you deliberately adapt the shared title and header design for an Arabic-first document.